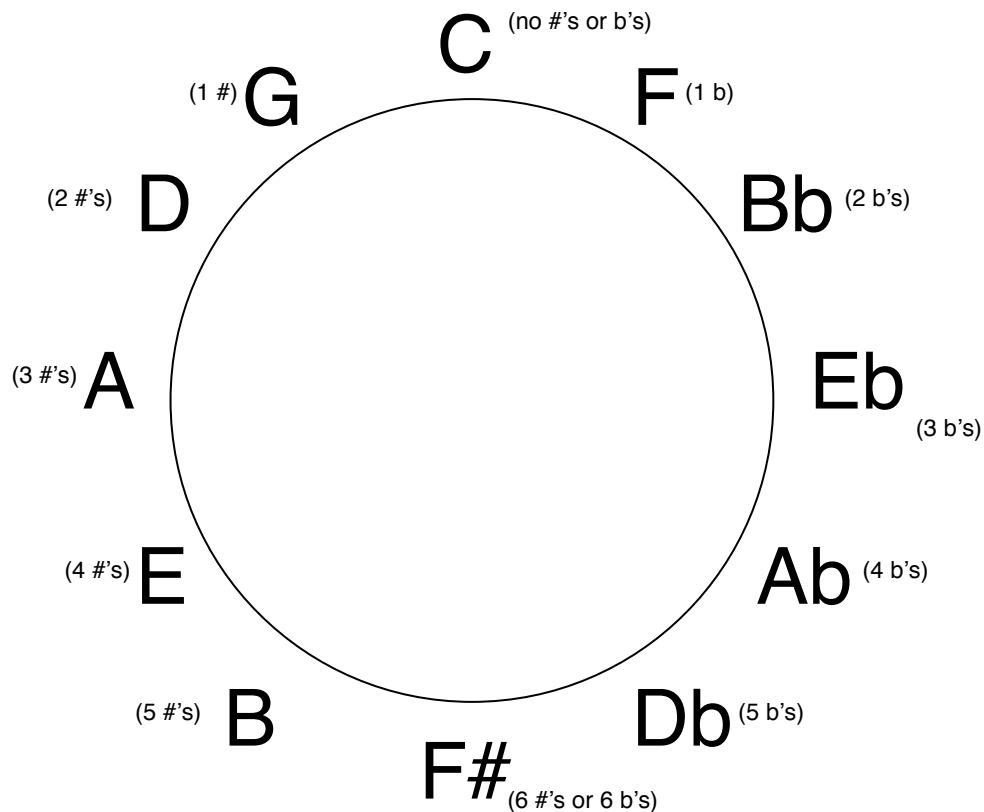


CIRCLE OF FOURTHS

FROM DIGGING DEEPER #90

The Circle of Fourths is probably the most important practice tool that you have at your disposal. It sets you up for what you'll see in the "real world" every day, songs and progressions that progress by ascending fourths. Every one of your practice sessions should have some overt Circle of Fourths practice in it, or at the very least, some implied Circle of Fourths practice . . . playing jazz songs!



At its very core, the Circle of Fourths is simply an organization of the 12 pitches in Western music. But, this organization is incredibly powerful, and is so predictive and so helpful, both intellectually, and mechanically on our instruments. Finding tangible ways to use the Circle of Fourths daily is your mission. See the next page for some ideas to get you started.

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DiggingDeeperJazz@gmail.com

CIRCLE OF FOURTHS (pg. 2)

1

C F F B^b B^b E^b E^b A^b

(half step) (half step) (half step) (half step)

A^b D^b D^b G^b F[#] B B E

E A A D D G G C

2

C F B^b E^b A^b D^b

F[#] B E A D G C

Practice anything you can think of around the Circle Of Fourths . . .

- Scales, Licks, Melodic Devices, Patterns, Chord Progressions, Intervals, etc.